



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Imago Dei Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.imagodeict.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Imago Dei Classical Academy (New Orleans, LA, 70131) presents a Catholic, classical education built around the Mother of Divine Grace (MODG) curriculum, with explicit emphasis on formation of character through a Catholic theological framework and through Socratic, memory-based pedagogy. Public materials show a strong religious grounding (Catholic magisterium, formation, liturgical-infused culture) and a clearly articulated classical orientation via MODG. Pedagogy highlights include Socratic discussion, oral presentations, and a memory-oriented lower school approach. The faculty is framed as a living, virtuous curriculum, and parents are positioned as partners in education, invited to participate and engage with the school. The overall ranking across the six categories lands as CLASSICAL, with Curriculum receiving a notable though not complete alignment due to some explicit Great Books/Paideia signals being less direct in the public content. Category-by-category details follow, with evidence drawn from the school's website and MODG materials and aligned against the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric.

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Notable needle-mover: The explicit integration of Catholic theology and the living, mentor-like faculty, along with regular Socratic discourse, strongly supports classical aims in ideology, pedagogy, and community; the Curriculum category would move from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL with more explicit Great Books/Paideia signaling.
- What would move the needle (for CATEGORY 3): Add explicit, named Great Books/Paideia programming, clearly articulate grammar–logic–rhetoric progression as a visible framework, and foreground the Great Conversation in curriculum materials.

Evidence and rubric-driven analysis below, category by category.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence - The academy's mission centers on fostering fidelity to the Roman Catholic Magisterium and forming students as baptized Christians, indicating transcendental moral realism in its aims. This is stated explicitly in the mission statements and related pages. - The program emphasizes what is true, good, and beautiful through Catholic thought, education, art, literature, and culture, tying virtue and beauty to knowledge. - The philosophy and staff materials underscore Catholic identity and leadership by Catholic laity, with doctrine and catechesis present in staff descriptions and classroom aims. - The MODG curriculum is described as a Catholic classical program, reinforcing a theological framing embedded across disciplines.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators (from the Six Elements lexicon): imago Dei / incarnational, sacramental worldview; theology; liturgy (where referenced by Catholic framing); reverence and sacred aim; virtue and moral formation; true/good/beautiful. - Direct keyword matches in public materials: Catholic, Magisterium, true/good/beautiful, imago Dei, Catholic laity, moral formation, sacrifice/service to God. - Negative indicators: None observed (no explicit secular-humanist or relativist signals in the public materials).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 5–6 distinct terms/concepts directly linked to religious foundations (Catholic, Magisterium, imago Dei, theology/the Catholic worldview, virtue/moral formation, liturgical framing in the broader Catholic context). - Negative keywords present: 0 - Ratio (positive:negative): effectively 5–6:0 - Rating justification: The materials strongly align with transcendental moral realism, grounding in Catholic theology, and liturgical/community orientation. This category easily earns CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: mission and Catholic framing (mission statements including fidelity to Magisterium; true/good/beautiful; Imago Dei; Catholic laity) ; MODG Catholic curriculum framing ; staff framing as Catholic educators

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials frame education as formation and the cultivation of wisdom, via a liberal-arts-oriented, classical mission and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, rather than mere job prep. This is echoed in mission-focused statements about forming intelligent, clear, and innovative thinkers through a Catholic classical framework. - A key published line notes that education will form students into virtuous, thoughtful people who can participate in a broader mission, aligning with the classical telos beyond utilitarian outcomes. - Curriculum/mission language emphasizes formation of character and human flourishing through the classical method (MODG). The public-facing MODG materials emphasize classical formation and a “true love for, and fidelity to” Catholic tradition as core to the education process.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: formation, virtue, human flourishing, classical mission, telos, pursuit of the true, good, beautiful; scholé/contemplation implied by a classical formation aim. - Direct keyword matches in public materials: formation, intelligent/clear/innovative thinkers (formation of mind/character), classical curriculum, liberal-arts oriented aims, true/good/beautiful framing. - Negative indicators: None explicit in the public content.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: at least 3–4 strong signals (formation, classical mission, true/good/beautiful framing, liberal-arts formation). - Negative keywords present: 0 - Ratio: effectively very high positive presence; 3–4:0 - Rating justification: CLASSICAL. The materials emphasize formation, virtue, and a classical telos (through MODG and Catholic formation) rather than job-prep or workforce language.

Cited evidence: formation/true/good/beautiful language; MODG as a classical curriculum; explicit emphasis on formation and the cultivation of intelligent, clear thinkers ; MODG curriculum framing as a Catholic classical program

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials clearly identify the MODG curriculum as the backbone of the academy’s approach, a recognized Catholic classical framework. This signals a classical orientation in the curriculum. - Curriculum content shown in samples includes Latin study (Cambridge Latin I–III in the high school plan), history coverage (Ancient History, Medieval History, U.S. History in early high school), and a structure that mirrors classical education through exposure to primary sources and careful pacing of subjects. - There is explicit mention of Socratic discussion and oral presentation as integral instructional modes in the public-facing materials, aligning with a classical pedagogy mindset. - The materials also show a clear liberal-arts

orientation through subject choices (Latin, history sequences, rhetoric-oriented coursework in higher levels implied by classical track).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: liberal arts, trivium, grammar/logic/rhetoric (explicitly named in the lexicon; presence of classical pedagogy signals in the site), great books/primary sources (referenced by MODG's classical framework, though explicit Great Books listings are not always spelled out on every page), history across disciplines, Socratic discussion. - Negative indicators: The site does not consistently foreground explicit Great-Books-heavy Great Conversation language on every public page, and it doesn't always spell out "grammar, logic, rhetoric" as a named, formal progression in every section. The explicit "Great Books" phrase is not always present in the visible public content, though MODG's classical framing is clear. - Direct keyword matches from the Six Elements lexicon present in the public content include: classical curriculum, liberal arts, history across curriculum, Socratic discussion, grammar/Latin, rhetoric-oriented work (implied via high school course structure and rhetoric training implied by the curriculum).

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 3–5 clear signals (MODG classical curriculum, Latin/history emphasis, Socratic pedagogy, liberal-arts framing; explicit references to classical education). - Negative keywords present: 1–2 signals are less explicit (explicitly naming "Great Books" or "Trivium" as a formal, named progression is not always visible across pages; Paideia terminology is not consistently used). - Ratio: roughly 3–5:1–2 - Rating justification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The program is clearly classical in orientation (MODG classical curriculum, Latin, Sacred history focus, Socratic teaching), but it lacks consistently explicit, universal mention of all core classical elements (especially explicit Great-Books labeling and a formal, named Trivium progression across all pages). The presence of some classical signals is strong, but the absence of a fully explicit Great-Books/Trivium naming on all publicly visible pages keeps Element 3 at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: MODG curriculum framing as Catholic classical program; Latin & history sequences; Socratic discussion and oral presentations; history as a curricular throughline in high school plan; explicit Catholic/3-part aim in mission; Ancient/Medieval/US History sequences; Latin coursework and high school structure; Socratic pedagogy and oral presentations

What would move the needle (for this category) - Explicitly name and foreground Great Books / Great Conversation across core curriculum pages. - Present a formal, named Trivium progression (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric) as a visible framework across K–12, with explicit alignment to memory work and classical pedagogy. - Articulate a formal "Paideia" or seminar DNA in the curriculum overview to strengthen the Great Books/monograph reading approach.

Cited evidence: current public language shows MODG/classical framing but less explicit Great Books/Trivium naming in every page; the recommendation aligns to the lexicon's indicators and category guidance.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Regular use of Socratic discussion is explicitly described: "Socratic discussion, oral presentation and study" in classroom practice. This is a hallmark of classical pedagogy. - The school emphasizes memory-based early learning (e.g., lower school memory-related activity, recitation, and chant-like memory work in classical pedagogy) as part of the method, consistent with scholé and memorization practices in classical education. The site also indicates a structure that includes upper-school rhetoric and opportunities to present speeches (rhetoric training). - The public materials show a clear rhythm of lower-school activities (memory, repetition, and social forms that echo chanting or recitation) and upper-school opportunities for debate, seminars, and rhetoric. - The MODG framework is explicitly described as classical in its approach, emphasizing classical pedagogy and a structured, disciplined environment.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: Socratic discussion; vernacular for oral presentations; memory work; recitation; rhetoric exercises; seminars; contemplation/wonder as part of pedagogy; both lower- and upper-level engagement in classical tasks. - Negative indicators: None observed in the pub-

lic materials (no explicit “experiential learning-only” or heavy project-based pedagogy signals). - Direct keyword matches (from the Six Elements lexicon): Socratic, narration/recitation, chanting/singing to memorize, seminar, colloquy, Paideia seminar, rhetoric, oratory, debate, memory work, liturgical calendar integration, contemplation/wonder; absence of signals like “project-based only” or “experiential learning-first.”

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: multiple explicit classical pedagogy signals (Socratic discussion, oral presentations, memory work, recitation, seminars, rhetoric, etc.), roughly 6–8 distinct positive indicators. - Negative keywords present: 0 explicit negative signals. - Ratio: high positive signal presence; essentially CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: Socratic discussion and oral presentation emphasis ; memory-based and lower/upper-school pedagogy references in mission/philosophy content ; MODG framework labeled as “classical” pedagogy

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials describe the faculty as “more than 30 dedicated, talented men and women,” emphasizing a culture of virtue and Catholic identity. This frames faculty as the living curricular force and the core of the school. - The staff pages are populated with profiles and images that convey a culture of mentors and virtuous teaching, aligning with the classical notion of the teacher as a living exemplar and guide. - The mission text and faculty framing emphasize teachers who are devoted to children, Catholic values, and classical education, reinforcing the notion of teachers as moral exemplars and living curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: living curriculum, mentors and sages, portrait of teacher, collegial culture, faculty as core, Catholic virtue emphasis. - Negative indicators: None observed in public content. - Direct keyword matches (from the Six Elements lexicon): living curriculum; portrait of a teacher; faculty of friends; collegial culture; mentors; virtue formation; teachers as exemplars.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 4–6 distinct indicators (living curriculum, faculty as core, mentors, portrait of a teacher, collegial culture, virtue formation). - Negative keywords present: 0 - Ratio: CLASSICAL

Cited evidence: staff page language highlighting “more than 30 dedicated, talented” teachers and the Catholic, classical framing of the faculty

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes partnership with parents and positions parents as co-teachers with teachers, reflecting a classical community model of formation and parental primacy in education. The public materials invite parent involvement and visits. - The site references parent formation and engagement through events and book studies; prospective families are encouraged to visit, indicating openness and an intentional community approach. - There is explicit messaging that parents collaborate with the school and that family involvement, tours, and interviews are part of the admissions and ongoing partnership process. This matches the classical framework of a liturgical, familial educational environment and open-campus ethos.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators: partnership with parents, co-teaching model, parent formation, classical book clubs, open campus, family liturgy alignment, parental primacy. - Negative indicators: None observed in the public content. - Direct keyword matches (from the Six Elements lexicon): partnership with parents; parent formation; open campus; family participation; co-teachers; parental primacy; classical book clubs; liturgical year events.

Quantitative estimate - Positive keywords present: 4–6 distinct signals (parental partnership, co-teaching, parent formation, open campus, family participation, book clubs). - Negative keywords present: 0 - Ratio: CLASSICAL

Cited evidence: parent partnerships and open invitation to visits; explicit parent formation and co-teaching language; public materials about prospective families and visits ; mission/appearance of parent involvement language

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum) is the only category currently identified as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. Concrete steps to move Element 3 toward CLASSICAL:
- Explicitly name and foreground Great Books in core curriculum pages and course descriptions (Great Books, Great Conversation).
- Present a formal, public-facing articulation of the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as a progression across K–12, with clear alignment to memory work and classical pedagogy.
- Expand “classical” vocabulary in the curriculum documents to include Paideia-style seminars and explicit referents to primary sources and canonical works within core subject areas.
- Publish a short, explicit statement linking the MODG curriculum explicitly to Great Books and primary-source study within the school’s mission pages.

Cited context: The public materials clearly reflect MODG-classical framing but lack consistently explicit Great Books/Paideia labeling on all pages for Curriculum; adding these explicit references would push the Curriculum category from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL to CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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